

# PCO of the Year

This Award recognises a professional conference organisation company that has delivered an event or events at a consistently exceptional level over a 12 month period.

## Eligibility Requirements

Entries in this Category must adhere to the following rules to be considered for an Australian Event Award:

1. Entries may be submitted by or on behalf of a Company registered in Australia (the Entrant).
2. All achievements referred to in the entry must relate to work performed at or in relation to the delivery of a specific event or events.
3. All events referred to in the entry must have taken place wholly between July 1, 2025 and June 30, 2026 or, in the case that part of the event(s) falls inside and part outside of these dates, the entrant must contact The Event Awards for a ruling from the Judging Panel on whether that event is eligible to be included in the entry.
4. Professional Conference Organisation must be the primary business of the Entrant.
5. All work referred to in the entry must have been principally accomplished by people who are Australian Citizens or Permanent Residents of Australia.
6. The Entrant must have the permission of the event owner(s) to mention an event or events in the entry.

## Judging Criteria

The judges will score each entry against the following criteria:

1. Quality of the Entrant's Work
  - a. Degree to which the entrant has delivered high quality events that achieves industry excellence (20%)
  - b. Degree to which the entrant has consistently achieved the event objectives and met the needs of stakeholders (20%)
  - c. The level of innovation and/or creativity in the Entrant's work (20%)
2. Management and Production Processes (30%)
3. Degree to which claims made in the entry are supported with evidence such as reasons for the claim, statistics, independent commentary or stakeholder feedback (10%)

## Entry Form Questions

The entry form for this category contains the following questions:

- Save your entry often to minimise the risk of data loss. We recommend saving after you enter each question and after each image upload.
- Please upload images and videos one at a time, saving after each one.
- Your information is not saved or uploaded until you click the SAVE button at the bottom of this page. If you experience computer or internet problems without saving your data will be lost.
- All content which forms part of your entry must be written in full on this form. *(For clarity, links to external pages or videos will NOT be reviewed or assessed as part of your entry by the judges. Formatting, including tables, bullet points, fonts are not accepted in entries.)*

### SECTION 1 - Eligibility Requirements Check

*(Note: You must be able to answer 'Confirmed' to all questions in order for this entry to be eligible.)*

1. The entrant is a company registered in Australia
2. All achievements referred to in the entry relate to work performed at or in relation to the delivery of a specific event or events
3. All events referred to in this entry took place between 1 July 2025 and 30 June 2026, or I have written confirmation from the Australian Event Awards to include an event or events which took place part inside and part outside the eligibility period
4. Professional conference organisation is the entrant's primary business
5. The achievement was principally accomplished by people who are Australian Citizens or Permanent Residents of Australia
6. The entrant has permission from the event owner(s) to mention an event or events in the entry

### SECTION 2 - Entrant Information

7. Confirm that the Entrant stipulated above is financially solvent as at 16 July 2026 and is expected to remain financially viable for the next 12 months.
8. If your answer to the question above is 'no', please explain this situation. *(We understand that sometimes events are staged by organisations that are not going concerns. If this is the case, please explain why.)*
9. Provide the name of the Company.
10. Provide an overview of the entrant's services including organisational structure and quantity of permanent employees.

### SECTION 3 - About the Company

11. Describe the practices and systems used by the Entrant to deliver outstanding event outcomes during the year. *(For example in relation to stakeholder management, organisational leadership, encouragement of team work, financial management, project planning, etc.) Word Limit: 400 words.*
12. Outline any commitment of the Entrant to best practice techniques over the year. *(For example, address your commitment to corporate social responsibility, sustainability, equality, use of technology and/or legacy.) Word Limit: 300 words.*
13. Describe any processes the entrant has in place to measure customer satisfaction at the events. *Word Limit: 250 words.*

## **SECTION 4 - Optional Video**

14. Optionally, submit a video (maximum 3 mins) to support the entry. *(Online video submissions must be in mpeg, mp4, mov, avi or wmv format. File will not upload until you click save button at the bottom of this page.)*

## **SECTION 5 - About the Achievement**

Pick 3 events the entrant delivered during the entry period and for each event, provide a detailed case study of the entrant's work on the event, including:

- a. The entrant's contribution
  - b. The aims of the event and how they were achieved
  - c. The key stakeholders and how their needs were met
  - d. New or innovative practices and/or creative ideas you have implemented in the delivery of the event
  - e. The complexity of the event - any challenges faced in achieving the outcomes and how they were overcome. *(Challenges might be budget, human resources, expertise, technology, weather, time, safety, stakeholder relations, scale, positioning)*
  - f. Ensure you provide evidence substantiating any claims make. *(Evidence may include statistics, extracts from press articles, quotes from stakeholders including suppliers or attendees, and results from post event surveys or external evaluations.)*
15. Event 1 Case Study *Word Limit: 550 words.*
  16. If this event has been previously staged, what innovation have you implemented this year? *Word Limit: 100 words.*
  17. Submit a photograph or image that supports the first event case study. *(The photo should show the scale, complexity, set up, location etc. jpg format, high resolution preferred. File will not upload until you click save button at the bottom of this page.)*
  18. Provide a caption (including names of people and description of the photo) for the photograph above.
  19. Submit a second photograph or image that supports the first event case study. *(The photo should show the scale, complexity, set up, location etc. jpg format, high resolution preferred. File will not upload until you click save button at the bottom of this page.)*
  20. Provide a caption (including names of people and description of the photo) for the photograph above.
  21. Submit a third photograph or image that supports the first event case study. *(The photo should show the scale, complexity, set up, location etc. jpg format, high resolution preferred. File will not upload until you click save button at the bottom of this page.)*
  22. Provide a caption (including names of people and description of the photo) for the photograph above.
  23. Event 2 Case Study *Word Limit: 550 words.*
  24. If this event has been previously staged, what innovation have you implemented this year? *Word Limit: 100 words.*
  25. Submit a photograph or image that supports the second event case study. *(The photo should show the scale, complexity, set up, location etc. jpg format, high resolution preferred. File will not upload until you click save button at the bottom of this page.)*
  26. Provide a caption (including names of people and description of the photo) for the photograph above.
  27. Submit a second photograph or image that supports the second event case study. *(The photo should show the scale, complexity, set up, location etc. jpg format, high resolution preferred. File will not upload until you click save button at the bottom of this page.)*
  28. Provide a caption (including names of people and description of the photo) for the photograph above.

29. Submit a third photograph or image that supports the second event case study. *(The photo should show the scale, complexity, set up, location etc. jpg format, high resolution preferred. File will not upload until you click save button at the bottom of this page.)*
30. Provide a caption (including names of people and description of the photo) for the photograph above.
31. Event 3 Case Study *Word Limit: 550 words.*
32. If this event has been previously staged, what innovation have you implemented this year? *Word Limit: 100 words.*
33. Submit a photograph or image that supports the third event case study. *(The photo should show the scale, complexity, set up, location etc. jpg format, high resolution preferred. File will not upload until you click save button at the bottom of this page.)*
34. Provide a caption (including names of people and description of the photo) for the photograph above.
35. Submit a second photograph or image that supports the third event case study. *(The photo should show the scale, complexity, set up, location etc. jpg format, high resolution preferred. File will not upload until you click save button at the bottom of this page.)*
36. Provide a caption (including names of people and description of the photo) for the photograph above.
37. Submit a third photograph or image that supports the third event case study. *(The photo should show the scale, complexity, set up, location etc. jpg format, high resolution preferred. File will not upload until you click save button at the bottom of this page.)*
38. Provide a caption (including names of people and description of the photo) for the photograph above.
39. Upload a testimonial from your client or, if you did not have a client, a testimonial from your sponsor or event attendees. *(If you have more than one testimonial, please upload all testimonials collated into a single PDF document. Maximum limit of 5x A4 pages total. Persons providing testimonials should be prepared to be contacted by the judging panel for further information if required.)*

#### **Additional Information for Consideration of the Headline Category: Event Agency of the Year**

40. Winners in this category will be considered for Event Agency of the Year award. Is there any additional information that the judges should consider in deciding the recipient of Event Agency of the Year?

Should your entry be announced as the National Winner at the Event Awards Ceremony, a summary of the achievement will be announced.

41. Please provide a brief summary including:
  - a. What your company specialise in
  - b. Description of what the achievement is
  - c. How the achievement contributed to and benefitted the event(s) and attendee experience
  - d. What was unique and innovative about your achievement

*Word Limit: 100 words.*

#### **Entrant Acknowledgement and Media Information**

*Entries will be highlighted on our social media and if this entry becomes a National Nominee and/or Winner, we will promote it on our website, through our media partners and PR agency.*

42. Provide one or two paragraphs about the event written in media-release style. *(This information may be used to showcase your achievements, promote your National Nominee status and used during and after the Awards Ceremony. This information may also be provided directly to media outlets.)*

To assist us to showcase your achievements on our social media, submit: *(Note that images and videos may also be provided to media outlets and used at the Event Awards Ceremony and after the Ceremony.)*

43. **EITHER:** Submit a high-res photograph *(File will not upload until you click save button at the bottom of this page.)*
44. **OR:** A video (maximum 15 seconds) Video must be in MP4 format, no larger than 29MB. Must be one of the following sizes:
- Square (W:1080px X H: 1080px)
  - Horizontal (W:1080px X H:608px)
  - Vertical (W:1080 x H:1350px)

The video could depict a moment from your event, achievement, innovation or product being used, yourself talking about the event/product, a video of your team hard at work, etc.

**NOTE:** Images or videos that do not meet the required specifications provided may result in the image or video not being usable on social media.

45. Provide a caption (including names of people) and a description of the photo or video provided above.
46. Please provide the names of the team you would like to acknowledge, and up to three Facebook social media handles - these social media handles will be used when recognising the entrant. *(We like to mention the people who make the event happen in our promotion of the entrants. Information may also be provided to media outlets.)*
47. **OPT OUT:** I do not wish to have my entry highlighted or showcased on your social media.

#### Entry Submission

48. This entry is complete and ready for Judging